

BALA KOPPARTHI

Sr. Software Quality Engineering Lead | AI-Enabled Test Automation Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Dynamic and strategic **Senior Software Quality Engineering Lead** with 19+ years of comprehensive expertise across the Software Testing Lifecycle, specializing in test management, AI-enabled automation, and leading high-performing global QA teams to deliver scalable, release-ready solutions. Proven track record of driving quality excellence across enterprise-scale platforms in retail, e-commerce, and utility domains, consistently enhancing customer experience and delivering measurable business outcomes.

Results-oriented leader who combines deep analytical thinking with solution-focused execution, leveraging strong capabilities in project management, risk assessment, and stakeholder engagement to drive innovation, optimize delivery, and uphold rigorous quality standards across complex technology initiatives. Experienced in embedding DevOps and CI/CD practices, enabling continuous testing and accelerated release cycles.

Demonstrated ability to build and mentor collaborative cross-functional teams across global regions (NA, EMEA, APAC), fostering strong partnerships and clear communication to align technology initiatives with organizational objectives. Adept at scaling QA operations, standardizing governance models, and implementing AI-driven testing strategies to improve efficiency, reduce costs, and elevate engineering productivity.

Extensive experience leading QA transformations and delivering high-impact solutions for industry leaders including Nike, PGE, Walmart, Lowe's, and GAP, with deep domain expertise in Retail and Utility sectors.

CORE EXPERTISE

- Quality Engineering Leadership • Test Strategy & Governance • AI-Driven Testing
- Test Automation (UI/API) • CI/CD & DevOps Enablement • Agile/Waterfall Delivery
- Defect & Release Management • Stakeholder Engagement • Global Team Leadership
- Functional Testing • Test Data Management • Root Cause Analysis • Quality Management
- End-to-End Software Testing Lifecycle Management • Cross-Functional Collaboration
- QA Team Leadership • Strategic Risk Management • Program Delivery • Retail & Utility Domain Expertise

KEY IMPACT

- Delivered 75+ enterprise programs with 100% on-time delivery and zero-defect leakage.
- Reduced test design effort by 40% using AI tools (Copilot, Cursor AI)
- Achieved \$200K+ annual cost savings through automation BOT implementations
- Improved regression efficiency by 25–35% via scalable automation frameworks
- Scaled QA teams and standardized delivery across global programs (NA, EMEA, APAC)
- Recognized with Nike Maxim Award, Global Mentor Award, Customer Delight Award

TECHNOLOGY STACK

AI & Innovation

- Microsoft Copilot • Cursor AI • ChatGPT • Databricks AI • Claude Code & Cowork

Performance & API

- JMeter • Postman • BRUNO • SOAP UI • API testing

Automation

- Selenium • Playwright • Cypress • TestNG • Cucumber • TestCafé • BrowserStack
- Cross-browser & cross-OS testing

DevOps

- Jenkins • Maven • Docker • GitHub • Bitbucket • Git

Enterprise Platforms

- Salesforce (Certified Admin) • IBM Sterling OMS • Oracle CC&B/MDM/ODM • Maximo • SAP
- JIRA (Atlassian) • HP ALM

Languages & Web

- JavaScript • Python • SQL • HTML • CSS • JSON • XML • .NET

Cloud

- AWS, Azure | Service Models: IaaS, PaaS, SaaS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Quality Engineering Lead

Dec 2021 - Present

NIKE, INC. • Beaverton, OR

Lead quality engineering for global digital commerce platforms operating across 190+ countries, supporting high-volume consumer transactions.

- Led adoption of AI-driven testing (Copilot, Cursor AI), reducing test design effort by 40% and accelerating release cycles
- Established and executed functional test plans and quality metrics for digital commerce initiatives, ensuring comprehensive coverage across UI, API and integration layers
- Built and scaled reusable end-to-end automation frameworks for UI and API testing (Playwright, Selenium) and API validation with Postman, achieving high automated coverage and reducing manual testing by 20%
- Delivered automation-led cost optimization initiatives, generating \$200K+ annual savings
- Introduced AI-based script generation and debugging approaches to improve engineering productivity
- Delivered 75+ enterprise releases with zero defect leakage and consistent on-time delivery
- Integrated automated suites with CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and Git-based workflows to enable continuous testing, automated deployments and faster feedback loops
- Led testing for major initiatives including Nike.com Exchanges, OMOBO platform, COFO, and Swoosh Desk (Salesforce), coordinating business analysts, product, engineering and client stakeholders for end-to-end validation
- Developed and executed comprehensive User Acceptance Testing plans, identifying and resolving critical defects within the Software QA lifecycle.
- Designed and implemented detailed test cases for all System, Integration and Regression Testing cycles, identifying and resolving defects to maintain high QA standards.
- Successfully executed multi-phase migration programs with zero customer impact through comprehensive system, integration, and regression suites
- Managed and scaled global QA teams (onshore/offshore), improving delivery efficiency by 25% through standardized frameworks, runbooks, and knowledge-sharing practices
- Established standardized test strategies, governance models, and operational runbooks to support enterprise delivery and operational excellence
- Managed large-scale testing across NA, EMEA, APAC regions, ensuring consistent quality standards and scalable cross-browser/cross-OS coverage via BrowserStack and automation harnesses
- Mentored teams on automation, Playwright, CI/CD practices, AI adoption, and quality best practices to elevate organizational QA maturity
- Ensured the quality of cloud-based solutions by developing and executing comprehensive test plans using various cloud technologies

- Oversaw test data management, environment provisioning and test execution cycles to support SIT, regression and E2E validation
- Led daily defect triage, performed root cause analysis and partnered with Product and Engineering teams to drive timely resolution and release readiness

Senior Software Quality Lead

Oct 2015 - Dec 2021

ERPA Group | Nike, INC & Portland General Electric. • Beaverton, OR

Nike Inc. is the world's leading supplier of athletic shoes & apparels and is also a major manufacturer of sports equipment, headquartered in Beaverton, Oregon.

Portland General Electric (PGE) is an integrated energy company serving over 950,000 customers with a 1.9 million population reach, focused on providing safe, reliable, and increasingly clean energy across Oregon.

- Led end-to-end Quality Engineering for global Order Management platforms across US, EU, and APAC, ensuring scalable, high-availability releases in distributed environments.
- Managed and mentored onsite and offshore QA teams, driving delivery excellence, sprint predictability, and quality governance across multiple time zones.
- Architected and executed enterprise-wide test strategies covering payments, fulfillment, and third-party integrations (PayPal, CSR) with deep API and database validation.
- Designed and enhanced robust automation frameworks using Selenium, TestNG, and Java, accelerating regression cycles and improving test coverage by 35%
- Integrated automated test suites into CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins, Maven, and Git, enabling continuous testing and faster, reliable deployments.
- Directed system-level validation across complex enterprise ecosystems including Oracle CC&B, MDM, ODM, and Maximo, ensuring data integrity and system interoperability.
- Spearheaded integration, end-to-end, and UAT testing across cross-functional platforms, reducing production defects and enhancing release confidence. \Delivered 100% data accuracy during large-scale data migration initiatives through rigorous validation, reconciliation, and SQL-based verification.
- Collaborated with product owners, architects, and engineering teams to define acceptance criteria, shift-left testing practices, and measurable quality KPIs.
- Tested and validated middleware solutions to guarantee data integrity and system performance.
- Built executive-level dashboards and reporting frameworks, providing real-time insights into quality metrics, defect trends, and release readiness.

QE Analyst

Sep 2014 - Sep 2015

Mavensoft Technologies | PORTLAND GENERAL ELECTRIC • Portland, OR

Portland General Electric (PGE) is an integrated energy company serving over 950,000 customers with a 1.9 million population reach, focused on providing safe, reliable, and increasingly clean energy across Oregon.

- Supported QA delivery for enterprise applications including Oracle OMS and Maximo systems
- Performed integration, system, and UAT testing, ensuring end-to-end validation
- Developed and maintained automation scripts to improve testing efficiency
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to manage defects and ensure quality releases
- Implemented Kanban methodologies to streamline workflows and improve efficiency in quality engineering processes.

QE Test Lead

Oct 2006 - Aug 2014

Infosys | Nike, Walmart, Lowe's, GAP. • USA, China, India

- Nike Inc. is the world's leading supplier of athletic shoes & apparels and is also a major manufacturer of sports equipment, headquartered in Beaverton, Oregon.
- Wal-Mart is a premier, tech-powered omnichannel retailer and the world's largest private employer, serving 270 million+ weekly customers through a global network of stores, high-growth e-commerce company.
- Lowe's Companies, Inc. is a FORTUNE® 50 home improvement retailer serving homeowners with a robust omnichannel e-commerce platform.
- Gap, Inc. is an American clothing and accessories retailer based in San Francisco, California.
- Led offshore QA teams supporting US and EMEA markets, ensuring high-quality delivery
- Led QA delivery for retail, labor management, and enterprise e-commerce platforms across web, mobile, and mainframe systems, ensuring high-quality releases through robust Test Strategy, stakeholder alignment, and

end-to-end ownership.

- Applied scrum principles to enhance the quality assurance process and improve product delivery timelines
- Leveraged solution design expertise to identify and mitigate potential quality risks.
- Designed and implemented scalable Test Automation frameworks using Selenium WebDriver, QTP, and BDD (Cucumber with Ruby), significantly improving regression efficiency and automation coverage.
- Owned end-to-end QA lifecycle including test planning, RTM, test data management, execution, and defect lifecycle management, ensuring traceability and adherence to Agile and Waterfall methodologies.
- Led functional, system, integration, and database testing (DB2) for complex enterprise and POS systems, validating business-critical workflows and ensuring data integrity across applications.
- Directed QA for large-scale e-commerce transformation programs including mPOS, DTC, and Global Store Solutions, validating multi-tenant platforms and third-party integrations across US, Canada, and EMEA markets.
- Spearheaded defect management and root cause analysis processes, reducing defect leakage and improving overall product quality through structured reporting, triage, and continuous improvement initiatives.
- Ensured adherence to SDLC best practices throughout the software development lifecycle to maintain high-quality standards
- Acted as a hands-on SDET/QA Lead by contributing to automation scripting, framework enhancements, and code reviews, while mentoring team members and strengthening technical capabilities.
- Established and improved QA processes aligned with CMMI Level 4 & 5 standards, driving process excellence, quality governance, and consistent delivery across enterprise programs.
- Collaborated with stakeholders, product owners, and development teams to define acceptance criteria, mitigate risks, and deliver high-quality releases, earning recognition through awards such as Global Mentor and Customer Delight.
- Key Projects: Nike mPOS/Assist, DTC, Global Store Solutions, Agile Enhancements, Grand Slam, Walmart MTcP Canada, Walmart China, Retail and Labor applications at GAP

CERTIFICATIONS

Salesforce Certified Administrator Salesforce	Jul 2019
AI for Everyone DeepLearning.AI	Apr 2026
Microsoft Copilot Fundamentals Microsoft	May 2025
Build Your Leadership Skills HEC Paris	May 2022

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Nike Maxim Award Nike	Aug 2023
Global Mentor Award Infosys	Mar 2011
Customer Delight Award Infosys	Apr 2011